

Impax Asset Management (IPX LN) — Sustainable-Investing Peer Comparison

Listed & unlisted pure-play comparables · Current AUM and 5-year trajectory · As at 17 July 2026

The subject — Impax Asset Management plc (IPX LN): London-listed sustainable / environmental-markets specialist (long-only thematic + systematic equities, fixed income, private infrastructure). AUM peaked at £37.2bn in FY21 and has since roughly halved — the decisive break was the loss of the **St. James's Place mandate (~£6.2bn)**, which drove a 30% drop in FY25.

AUM (FY end 30 Sep): £37.2bn (FY21) → £35.7 (FY22) → £37.4 (FY23) → £37.2 (FY24) → £26.1 (FY25) → **£23.3bn (30 Jun 2026)**

1 · Listed pure-play / near-pure-play sustainable managers

Competitor	Ticker / Owner	Listed	Investment area	Current AUM	AUM development — last 5 years
Australian Ethical Investment	ASX: AEF	Listed	True pure-play — ethical / sustainable superannuation + managed funds, governed by its Ethical Charter	A\$14.5bn ≈£7bn · Jun 2026 · record	A\$6.9bn (FY21) → 6.2 → 9.2 → 10.4 → 13.9 → 14.5 . Strong growth: super inflows, Christian Super & Altius mergers, CEFC deal.
Foresight Group	LSE: FSG	Listed	Near-pure-play — sustainability-led infrastructure / renewables + regional private equity (owns WHEB)	£13.0–13.1bn FY26 · continuing ops	£8.8bn (FY22) → 12.2 → 12.1 → 13.2 → 13.0 . Steady growth. NB: FY26 on a continuing-ops basis (divesting public-equities arm).
Gresham House	was AIM: GHE	Private since Dec 2023	Near-pure-play — sustainable real assets: forestry, renewables, battery storage, sustainable housing	~£8.5bn last reported · Dec 2023	~£2.8bn (FY19) → 4.0 → 6.5 → 7.8 → 8.5 . Rapid growth, then taken private by Searchlight (£470m); owner targets £20bn by 2030.

2 · Unlisted / privately-held pure-play sustainable managers

Competitor	Ticker / Owner	Listed	Investment area	Current AUM	AUM development — last 5 years
Generation Investment Mgmt	Private Gore / Blood, partner-owned	Unlisted	Pure-play sustainability — global & Asia equity, growth & private equity, Just Climate platform	US\$24.7bn ≈£18bn · Mar 2026	~\$36bn peak (2022) → ~33.8 → ~31.3 (Jun 2025) → 24.7 . Declining on ESG outflows + marks.
Osmosis Investment Mgmt	Private management-owned	Unlisted	Pure-play — systematic "Resource Efficiency" quant equities + climate credit	~US\$17bn ≈£13bn · Jan 2026	~\$2bn (2020) → ~\$10bn (Oct 2024) → \$17bn . Rapid growth.
Mirova	Natixis IM Groupe BPCE	Unlisted	Pure-play affiliate — Article 9 equities, bonds, energy-transition infra, natural capital	€33bn ≈£28bn · Sep 2025	€23.9bn (Q1 2021) → 28 → 29.7 → ~33 . Growth then plateau.
WHEB Asset Management	Foresight LSE: FSG	Unlisted sub of FSG	Pure-play — single global mid-cap sustainable / impact equity strategy	~£0.8bn at 2025 sale	~£1bn (2021) → ~£0.8bn . Modest decline, then acquired by Foresight (early 2025).
Triodos Investment Mgmt	Triodos Bank	Unlisted	Pure-play impact — energy & climate, inclusive finance, food & agri, impact equities & bonds	€5.4bn ≈£4.6bn · Jun 2025	~€5–6bn range throughout. Broadly flat (€5.8bn Dec-24 → €5.4bn Jun-25).
Parnassus Investments	AMG NYSE: AMG	Unlisted sub of AMG	Largest US pure-play ESG fund house — concentrated ESG-integrated equities	~US\$41bn ≈£30bn · early 2026	\$47bn (2021) → ~50 (2024) → 45.6 → ~41 . Declining on ESG-demand softness.
Calvert Research & Mgmt	Morgan Stanley NYSE: MS	Unlisted sub of MS	Pure-play responsible-investing brand — active/passive equity, fixed income, 5 ETFs	~US\$40bn ≈£30bn · 2025	~\$36bn (2023) → ~\$40bn (2025). Modest growth.
Trillium Asset Management	Perpetual ASX: PPT	Unlisted sub of PPT	Pure-play SRI/ESG pioneer (est. 1982) — active equities + fixed income, shareholder advocacy	~US\$4.8bn ≈£3.6bn · Sep 2025	~\$3.3bn (2020) → 4.5 → ~4.8bn . Modest growth.

3 · Diversified managers with large sustainable franchises (context — not pure-play)

Competitor	Ticker / Owner	Listed	Investment area	Current AUM	AUM development — last 5 years
Liontrust Asset Mgmt	LSE: LIO	Listed	Sustainable Investment (~£8.1bn) is its largest fund range (~40%), but firm is diversified	£19.6bn AuMA Mar 2026	£33.5bn (FY22) → 31.4 → 27.8 → 22.6 → 19.6 . Persistent decline (retail outflows).
Ninety One	LSE: N91 JSE: NY1	Listed	Sustainability / transition-finance franchise, but a broadly diversified global manager	£171.8bn Mar 2026	£143.9bn (FY22) → 129 → 126 → 131 → 171.8 . Jump on £18.3bn Sanlam take-on.

Polar Capital	LSE: POLR	Listed	Smart Energy / Smart Mobility thematic, but growth is overwhelmingly tech / AI-driven	£45.0bn Jun 2026	£22.1bn (FY22) → 19.2 → 21.9 → 21.4 → 30.6 → 45.0.
Robeco	ORIX TSE / NYSE	Unlisted sub of ORIX	Sustainability-integrated platform, but large & broadly diversified (not pure-play)	€228bn AUM €337bn total · Dec 2025	~€200bn range → €228bn (+13% in 2025).

How to read this

- **Closest pure-play comparables:** Australian Ethical (the only true *listed* pure-play), and among private / subsidiary names Generation, Osmosis, Mirova, Parnassus, Calvert, Trillium, Triodos and WHEB.
- **Sharp bifurcation (2024–26):** quant / resource-efficiency and diversified-growth names (Osmosis, AEF, Robeco) grew, while active fundamental sustainable-equity managers exposed to the ESG-outflow wave (Impax, Generation, Parnassus, Liontrust) contracted.

Caveats: Figures are in native reporting currencies; indicative £ conversions are rough (mid-2026 FX). Fiscal year-ends differ (Impax 30 Sep; AEF 30 Jun; Foresight / Liontrust / Ninety One / Polar 31 Mar; Gresham 31 Dec). Private-firm AUM histories (Generation, Osmosis, Triodos, WHEB) are triangulated from press & firm disclosures and are approximate. Sources: company IR / annual reports & AUM updates, Investgate/RNS, FT, Reuters, Citywire, Investment Week, Portfolio Adviser, Morningstar.